Less Code,
More Decisions.

GURUNATH PARASARAM

1

THE SPECTRUM

Three Ways to Work With an Agent

FLUID

Vibe Coding

You and the agent discover the work together through conversation. Fast, creative, ideal for prototypes and ideation.

STRUCTURED

Agentic Coding

The agent plans and executes inside tool-rich loops with your oversight. For features you're shipping.

ORCHESTRATED

Agentic Engineering

Specs drive multiple agents in parallel. Reviews automate. For systems you'll own for years.

> *"You are not writing the code directly 99% of the time. You are orchestrating agents who do and acting as oversight."*
>
> Andrej Karpathy · X, Dec 26 2025 · x.com/karpathy/status/2004607146781278521

ASK THE ROOM

Which mode is your default today — and does it match the work you're doing?

2

THE FIRST DECISION

What To Build

01 Instructions › 02 PRD.md › 03 Impl Guide.md › 04 Tests › 05 Code › 06 Iterate

↻ *loop back on any step*

The markdown is the contract.

The code is a derivative.

You review thinking, not syntax.

LIVE DEMO

Raw instruction
→ PRD.md
→ Impl Guide.md

3

THE SECOND DECISION

What the Agent Sees

FORMAT

Instructions.md

How the agent communicates & formats.

DOMAIN

Skills.md

Reusable patterns for recurring task types.

CONTEXT

Pin, don't describe

@file paths and explicit tables in the query.

EXECUTE

Cell-by-cell

Agent runs one cell at a time. You verify, advance.

FOR EDA · Loosen the controls. Specify the question, not the method. ▶️ **Demo: open-ended EDA prompt**

4

THE THIRD DECISION

What Counts as Done

THE REVIEW GAP · **Code creation sped up. Human review didn't.**

Demo: agent review on a small PR

Agent writes. Agent reviews. Human decides.

ASK THE ROOM

Would you trust an agent's review more, the same, or less than a peer's?

5

REFRAMES WORTH LEAVING WITH

What This Unlocks

01

Code isn't binding

Specs regenerate to new languages or frameworks.

02

Custom beats rigid

Bespoke code was expensive. That math flipped.

03

OOP with real flexibility

Proper classes and extensibility — not scripts.

04

Onboarding collapses

Weeks to days. The agent is the tour guide.

05

Docs stay in sync

Living specs become living documentation.

The discipline doesn't slow you down. It's what makes the speed safe to use.

ONE OPEN QUESTION

When, exactly, does the spec get written?

UPFRONT

Written in markdown first.

What you just saw.

DISCOVERED

Emerges through conversation.

The other valid answer.

Another open question: who writes the spec — one agent, or many?

DISCUSSION

- Where does the spec-driven approach feel too heavy?
- What part of review would you never hand to an agent?
- One habit you'd change this month, based on anything today?

Thank you. · Gurunath Parasaram